



Plantronics Voyager 855

Bluetooth with a difference

The Plantronics Voyager 855 is slightly different from other Bluetooth devices out in the market as it gives you a choice, not only for which ear you want to use it on, but also whether you want to use it on only one ear or add the extension that comes with it and use it with both ears.

This device is pretty light and slim, and only 2.5 inches in length. It is black with a shiny silver lining on the outer part. When putting it on, there is a chrome line that is clearly visible and gives a good look to the device. It also has a slot where you can add the detachable ear clamp. Ear-clamps are provided for both ear plugs. This device charges via a mini-USB port located on the rear of the device. Volume control buttons are located on the top and the mute button right next to them. The main button on the face is used to answer calls. This button layout is well thought out and you can easily answer or mute a call when needed.

The main feature of this device is its retractable microphone which gives you a stylish way to answer calls. In case you

want to cut the call, you just need to slide the mic back up.

The Voyager's performance is mediocre when it comes to listening to music. As for call clarity, it is above average, but the range might be a slight problem. When we tested it, we found the range for good audible, non-distorted voice clarity is somewhere around four to five metres without any obstacles. If there were any obstructions, the range would drop even further.

A feature that is missing with this bluetooth device is that it can't be paired with more than one phone. This feature may not be considered important by many. For those two phones, it would have been a plus. When using the second ear clamp in stereo mode, you are forced to use the larger loop that comes with it and not everybody might be comfortable with this.

The Plantronics Voyager 855 is a good, light-weight headset with decent sound clarity, but at Rs. 6,799, it seems too pricey



for what it has to offer. If you need a bluetooth headset to sync with multiple devices then this is definitely not for you, but if you want something that is stylish and grabs people's attention, then this makes a good choice.

Specifications:

Size: 2.3 x 0.6 x 0.5 inches, Weight: 15 grams (with stereo plug-in cable)

Ratings

Features: 7
Performance: 7.5
Build quality: 7
Value for money: 6
Overall: 7

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Price: Rs. 6,799

Epson EMP DM1

Theatre at home

Projectors are now going the home theatre way and are being made not only for businesses but also as a means of entertainment for the family. The Epson EMP DM1 is one such entry-level home theatre LCD projector that we received for testing.

Being an entry level projector, this has a native resolution of 854x480 and can support a maximum of 1280x1024 which is just a standard viewing resolution. With this resolution it is not ideal for 1080p.

The first thing you notice about this projector is that it has an integrated DVD player at the base which can also play DivX format. There is an eject button also located next to this. It comes with a white glossy finish and will fit right into your living room without a problem. There is also a handle on the side so you can carry it around. There is a manual shutter to protect the lens present on the top along with the few important controls that could fit on the projector such as power, source, play/pause, volume, etc.

The connections are located at the rear of the projector and these include VGA, Component-in and

Composite-in. There is also a Coaxial out and a USB port located where you can plug your flash drive, from which you can watch movies. There is no S-Video or HDMI port on this projector. An HDMI port is important as it removes the need for extra cables as both video and sound are carried in one.

The text displayed from the DM1 is not at all sharp and crisp, and although this is not meant for business purposes, even the occasional text files would not be enjoyed on this big a screen. We ran DisplayMate for this projector to adjust the brightness and contrast; once that was done we noticed that there is a problem with the primary colours for this projector. This was clearly seen towards the high intensity side of the 16 shade intensity test where the last two shades could not be distinguished. But in the case of blue the last three shades could not be distinguished. Cyan on Green was another noticeable colour flaw with this projector.

When we watched some movie clips and played a bit of Crysis with the DM1 we felt that the colours

were slightly on the warmer side, but the effect of playing on a big screen is really great. When watching movies, the overall experience was good, but at times the details are lacking.

Overall, this projector is just average; sure it has a DVD player, but the native resolution is just too low. The EMP DM1 is best used for popping in a DVD and playing, but if you want better quality and something with which you can project 1080p, then you should look elsewhere, as this just brings you the basics. Another option to look for is the reducing prices of LCD and Plasma TVs, which now also come with 1080p support.

Specifications:

Dimensions - 320 x 135 x 230 mm (W x H x D), Panel Size - 0.55" wide, Native Resolution: 854 x 480

Ratings

Features: 7
Performance: 6
Build quality: 7
Value for money: 6
Overall: 6

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